

M3 Reflective Essay

My self-perception has been strongly influenced by meaningful social interactions, particularly through my role as Vice President of Great Danes Esports, a non-mandated organization at AUF. Holding a leadership position allowed me to rediscover my passion for helping others and contributing to a shared goal. Through this role, I became more confident as I witnessed people placing their trust in me and responding positively to my leadership. The organization also encouraged me to become more socially engaged, as collaboration and communication were essential to fulfilling my responsibilities. These *experiences helped shape my identity* and reinforced my understanding of myself as someone capable of growth and responsibility within a social group.

In terms of my assumed public image, I believe that many people initially perceive me as unapproachable. Based on conversations with my friends, their first impression of me was that I appeared “*mataray*” or “*sassy*,” often associated with a serious facial expression or my “*RBF*” However, this perception tends to change as people engage in long-term interaction with me. Over time, others begin to recognize my extroverted personality and my genuine interest in building connections. As a result, I am often able to form friendships or at least establish familiarity with many people beyond their initial judgment.

Feedback from others largely confirmed my assumptions about how I am perceived, reinforcing the idea that first impressions do not fully represent a person’s self-concept. Reflecting on this experience through the lens of the *Looking-Glass Self*, I have come to understand that *identity is shaped through the interaction* between internal traits and external perceptions. My extroverted nature plays a significant role in reshaping how others view me over time. These patterns highlight that identity formation is not fixed but continuously developed through social interaction. Ultimately, my self-perception has been strengthened by recognizing that sustained relationships provide a more accurate understanding of who I am than initial appearances.